

Install & Use Guide for Phones (Android & iPhone)

This guide shows you how to put the app on your phone, set it up, and add a free AI key so it can help you draft lesson plans. Everything except the AI helper works with no internet once installed.

The app (one link, all phones)

<https://oc-lesson-planner.netlify.app>

Tip: Open this link in Chrome on Android (or Safari on iPhone). No account, no password, nothing to pay.

1. Install the app on your phone

On Android:

1. Open the **Chrome** browser and go to the app link above.
2. Tap the **three-dot menu** (top right of the browser).
3. Tap **Install app** (older phones: **Add to Home screen**).
4. Confirm - a Lesson Planner icon now appears on your home screen.
5. Open it from the home screen like any other app. It works even with no internet, and it stays updated automatically.

On iPhone (Safari):

1. Open **Safari** and go to the app link.
2. Tap the **Share** button (square with an arrow).
3. Tap **Add to Home Screen**, then **Add**.
4. Open the icon from your home screen.

On a computer (optional):

Open the link in Chrome or Edge and tap the install icon in the address bar (a monitor with a down arrow).

Tip: Install once, use forever offline. All your lesson plans are stored only on your own phone - no account, no cloud, no one else can see them.

2. First use - set up your profile

1. Open the app. On the welcome screen tap **Get Started**.
2. Fill in your **Name**, **School** and **Region**, then tap **Continue**.
3. You will see the 12 national syllabuses (Biology, Chemistry, Mathematics, Physics, History and more, Forms 1 to 5). Tap **Start Planning**.
4. You are now on the Dashboard. That's it - you can start planning.

Tip: You can change your name, school or region any time in Settings -> Profile. They appear on your exported lesson plans.

Choosing your subject and class

On a **phone**: tap the **hamburger menu** (the button with three lines, top left). A drawer slides out with a **Subject** dropdown and a **Class Level** dropdown. Pick your subject (for example Mathematics) and your class (Form 3). Only the class levels that exist for that subject are shown.

On a **computer**: the same Subject and Class Level dropdowns are always visible in the left sidebar.

3. Settings - add a FREE AI key (important)

The AI helper is optional. It drafts lesson plans for you, which saves a lot of time. It needs a **free API key** from one of four providers. You create the key on the provider's website (free, no credit card), then paste it into the app. The key is stored only on your phone and is sent only to that provider when you generate.

First, get a free key from one (or several) providers:

Gemini (Google)	aistudio.google.com/apikey
Key looks like	<code>AIza...</code>
Credit card?	No - just a free Google account
How to get it	1. Open the link and sign in with any Google account. 2. Tap Create API key and accept the terms. 3. Copy the key that appears (it starts with AIza...).
Groq	console.groq.com/keys
Key looks like	<code>gsk_...</code>
Credit card?	No - free account
How to get it	1. Open the link and create a free account (or sign in). 2. Tap Create API Key. 3. Copy the key (it starts with gsk_).
OpenRouter	openrouter.ai/keys
Key looks like	<code>sk-or-...</code>
Credit card?	No - free account, no card
How to get it	1. Open the link and create a free account. 2. Go to Keys and tap Create Key. 3. Give it a name such as lesson-planner, then copy the key (it starts with sk-or-). One key gives you many free models.
Mistral	console.mistral.ai
Key looks like	<code>long code (shown once)</code>
Credit card?	No - free account
How to get it	1. Open the link and sign up. 2. Open API Keys and tap Create new key. 3. Copy the key immediately (it is shown only once).

Now paste the key into the app:

1. Open the app and tap the **hamburger menu** (three lines, top left), then tap **Settings**.
2. Scroll to the **AI Configuration** card.
3. Paste your key into the matching box: **Gemini API key**, **Groq API key**, **OpenRouter API key** or **Mistral API key**.
4. Under **Preferred provider**, choose the one whose key you just entered (for example OpenRouter).
5. Next to **Model**, tap the **refresh icon** (two arrows). The app loads the current free models for your provider. Pick one from the dropdown.
6. Tap **Save AI Settings**.
7. Tap **Test Connection**. A green "Connection successful" message means everything is ready.

Tip: You can paste several keys and switch Preferred provider later - no need to delete the others. If you used OpenRouter, the "OpenRouter free router" model is the safest choice: it automatically picks a working free model for you.

Tip: Your API key is like a password - keep it private, and never share your backup file with API keys included.

Tip: Free AI models may learn from the text you send them. Do not type students' names, phone numbers or other personal details into AI-generated fields.

4. Using the app every day

The Progression grid (your map for the year)

Open **Progression** from the menu. It shows the whole school year as a 36-week grid for your subject and class: the module, chapter and topic for each week, how many periods it needs, and which weeks are evaluations or holidays. Tap any week to open (or create) its lesson plan. Use **Plan Next** to jump to your next unplanned week.

Creating a lesson plan

Open a week and the editor opens with that week's topic already filled in. Complete each section - you can type yourself or let the AI help:

1. Tap **Generate Full Lesson** to draft the whole plan (previous knowledge, objectives, activities, materials, full lesson notes, homework and more).
2. Review the preview and tap **Accept All**.
3. Or tap **Generate with AI** next to any single section to fill just that part.
4. Set the **Status** at the bottom: Planned, In Progress, Completed, Partial or Skipped.

Tip: Everything saves by itself as you type - there is no Save button for a lesson.

Tracking progress

The Dashboard shows this week's lesson and your overall completion. The **Progress** page shows how far you are in each of the six sequences, a colour-coded calendar of the 36 weeks, and an **Export Report** you can send to your head of department.

Exporting lesson plans

From any lesson plan tap **Export PDF** or **Export Word** for a print-ready document. The **Export** page lets you batch-export many lessons at once (a whole week, sequence or term) - ideal for inspectors and heads of department.

5. Tips & troubleshooting

After an app update

When a new version is released, the app updates by itself. If it ever looks old, fully close the app (swipe it away from recent apps) and reopen it once - the new version will load.

Back up your work

Your lesson plans live on your phone. To keep them safe, open **Settings -> Data** and tap **Export All Data (Backup)** at least once a month. Keep the downloaded file somewhere safe. You can restore it later with **Import Backup**, for example when you get a new phone.

AI not working?

1. Check that you are online (the header shows Online).
2. Open Settings -> AI Configuration and confirm your key is pasted in the box for your Preferred provider.
3. Tap the refresh icon next to Model to reload the free model list, then Save AI Settings.
4. Tap **Test Connection** - it will tell you exactly what is wrong.

Changing school or subject

Switch subject and class any time from the hamburger menu (phone) or sidebar (computer). Your old lessons stay on the device. Change your name and school in Settings -> Profile; they appear on exported plans.

Holiday dates

Cameroonian holiday dates change every year. At the start of each school year, open Settings -> Calendar and set the year start date, the Christmas and Easter breaks, then tap Save Calendar. The Progression grid updates automatically.

Tip: Need more detail? See the full HOW-TO-USE guide that comes with the app for every field and feature.

Lesson Planner - built for Cameroonian secondary school teachers.